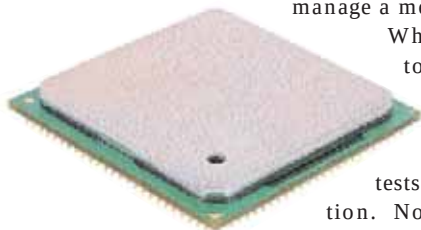


2.7 GBps. These impressive figures though, do not translate into the best solution for the application area of content creation.

The winner is the old workhorse, the AMD 1700+. At Rs 3,240, its STTI score of 77.37 seems all the more impressive. Close on its heels was the 2800+ but why shell out Rs 23,820, when a better solution costs some seven times less?

Going by pure benchmark numbers, the AMD Athlon XP 2800+ seemed to be running on steroids as it showed a serious sense of urgency by rendering the test image in our POVray benchmark in just 292 seconds—this was a serious blow to the P4 3.06 GHz processor as it was able to do the same but only after taking 43 seconds more. The main reason for this astounding performance is the XP's FPU. With its six processing pipelines, it makes number crunching look like child's play. Following close on the heels of the 2800+ was the 2700+, which too completed the test in an impressive time of just 302 seconds.

Next, as we move on to the SiSoft Sandra benchmarks, you will find that the P4 blasts through tests. In the CPU Normal benchmark, it was able to churn out a score of 9568. But what hit us on the head was the mind numbing score of 21855 in the FPU SSE (CPU Multimedia test). This score stamps the authority on the fact that the P4's inbuilt instructions are worth their salt. And the absence of support for SSE2 instructions is probably the reason why the AMD processors aren't able to post impressive scores in the synthetic benchmarks. This was further confirmed in the Specview Perf benchmark wherein the P4 3.06 GHz CPU scored a massive overall average score of 208.2 fps, while even the fastest AMD processor could manage a mere 138.6 fps.



Intel Celeron 1.7GHz:
Based on the Willamette core this processor is not a great performer

While theoretically SSEs seem to impress, practically they are rarely implemented with élan. This is evident when the Photoshop tests are taken into consideration. Note how the top number crunchers, the AMD 2800+ and the Intel P4 3.06 GHz, do almost equally well with Photoshop—SSE instructions make no difference to their performance.

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